

marketing tactic to tout the expensive AirPods (which look especially prone to getting lost). While it does excel at convenience as a bluetooth headset with a lot of nifty features, removal of the 3.5 mm jack had nothing to do with it. Apple going “all digital” has not helped audio technology sound better in any way, although to be fair they have helped it hear better (one of their nifty features is the noise cancellation algorithm in the AirPod mics). However, being a major player, Apple’s decision may influence other manufacturers to go the all digital way. This can be a good thing as long as manufacturers continue to enhance their wireless codecs or more of them continue to adopt technologies like Kleer and AptX.

For the audio industry, digital sound has been a blessing and a curse. Though the digital format offers advantages like unlimited accurate reproduction of original copies and near effortless worldwide distribution, this also brings with it a horde of security and policy headaches like piracy



Wired or wireless? That is the question